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Eyebrown: Case study 01

Title: Boosting core feature adoption and engagement through whimsical UX interventions

Subtitle: Illustration; Metrics analysis; UX/UI ; User delight

Summary: Throughout the year, a company managing 1,500+ employees across North America released seasonal themes to drive platform affinity. This project introduced a "ghost hunt" gamification layer to boost adoption of underused mobile features.

- **Role:** Product designer and Lead illustrator
- **Timeline:** 2 months
- **Deliverables:** In-app "ghost hunt," omni-channel email campaign, and performance analytics reports
- **Key Metric:** 64% avg email interaction rate; 164% avg feature adoption increase; 550% peak boost in profile interactions.

Problem

Data showed that several key features sat underused after 18 months live. These touchpoints were critical for operational efficiency, but business rules forbid mandating usage, so we needed an incentive-based way to drive interactions.

Solution

With Halloween approaching, the design team proposed a seasonal campaign to guide users toward these features—including the upcoming "Dark Mode" release. We launched an omni-channel campaign consisting of a series of timed emails and five hidden "ghosts" placed strategically near high-value, low-usage components. Each ghost was introduced via email with a unique backstory, transforming a standard UI task into a narrative-driven "hunt."

Process

Illustrations were locked by mid-September, and, as lead illustrator, I owned the ghosts' visual identity and backstory copy while shaping the campaign flow with the team. The seasonal theme itself launched across both desktop and mobile, but the hunt was mobile-only, since a strict two-week build window meant trading cross-platform reach for execution quality on a single, high-traffic surface. We also used the campaign's traffic spike to pull forward the Dark Mode release, making the "Dark Mode Toggle" the hunt's final destination.

Meet the ghosts

Ghoulfashioned — keeps every guest's glass full Piña Ghoulada — hands out the gift bags
Phantom Fizz — shares forgotten cocktail recipes Boourbon — stocks the bar before the party starts Apparition Spiritz — welcomes the newest teammates

Results

- **Adoption Spike:** All five targeted features saw increased engagement, with "Edit Profile" seeing a 550% boost.
- **Behavioral Attribution:** 66% of the initial Dark Mode adoption was directly attributed to users who engaged with the ghost hunt.
- **Email-to-App Conversion:** Data confirmed that ghosts with higher email open rates saw proportionally stronger component performance, validating our omni-channel strategy.

Conclusion:

This work isn't always visible to the end user just trying to get through their day. However, this didn't stop me from pouring my best into this Halloween campaign, both as an illustrator and product designer. Five ghosts, one goal: turning a routine work tool into something that could make a user's day a little brighter.